Zero to PLO50

Your study companion

24 small lessons. Selected resources. A clear next step.

Learn one idea

Watch or read the selected part, with the prerequisites already in place.

Practise it

Make a prediction, solve a drill and explain your reason.

Check it

Use an answer key, reference or peer before moving on.

Four-card PLO cash | English | Version 1.0 | 14 October 2026

How to use this companion

FOLLOW THE SEQUENCE

The short route tells you where you are going. For study, use the sequence and selected clips here. Work through the lessons in order; revisit them when your own hands reveal a gap.

ONE STUDY BLOCK

Plan about 30-60 minutes: learn the selected part, practise, then check. That is study time, not the duration of the video. Some lessons need more than one block.

REPEAT IN REAL HANDS

Finishing a clip is not completing a skill. Repeat the drills on another day and use marked hands from your current games.

BLUE TITLES ARE CLICKABLE

Time ranges tell you where to start and STOP. The link opens at the start; YouTube will keep playing beyond the selected end unless you stop it.

REFERENCE AND FEEDBACK

For factual drills, check pages 28-29. For strategy, compare the exact scenario with a suitable reference or a peer/coach. Ask about uncertainty; do not invent an answer.

KEEP THE FORMAT CLEAR

NLHE means two-card Hold'em; PLO here means four-card, six-max cash. Keep tournament, heads-up and five-card advice separate. No purchase is required by this syllabus.

Notation in drills: A = ace, K = king, Q = queen, J = jack, T = ten. Suits: ♠ spades, ♥ hearts, ♦ diamonds, ♣ clubs. 100bb = one hundred big blinds.

Your learning sequence

A Understand poker | lessons 01-06

Before real-money play

Explain the rules, position, a bet, pot odds and expected value.

B The Hold'em bridge | lessons 07-10

Alongside NL2-NL5

Choose hands by seat, explain a bet, reconstruct a hand and recognise tilt.

C Switch to four cards | lessons 11-12

Before your first PLO session

Always use exactly two hole cards and calculate a legal pot raise.

D Choose PLO hands | lessons 13-15

PLO2 onward

Describe all four cards, use the right reference and reassess aces after the flop.

E Read the PLO board | lessons 16-22

Build at PLO2; revisit at PLO5-PLO10

Recognise nut potential, draws, dirty outs, stack depth and card removal.

F Study with purpose | lessons 23-24

Repeat through PLO25-PLO50

Practise preflop regularly and turn reviewed mistakes into a weekly study target.

Skill checks are learning checkpoints. Stakes, volume, finances and stable evaluation remain governed by the main route. PLO preflop practice continues throughout stages D-F.

What beats what?

Identify the best five-card hand without guessing.

BEFORE YOU START None. Start here.

WATCH / READ

PokerStars Learn | VIDEO

How to Play Poker for Beginners

00:41-02:27

LOOK FOR THIS

Watch the hand-ranking section. Practise recognising the categories before learning strategy.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

A higher-looking card does not beat a higher hand category. Compare the complete five-card hand.

DO THIS

Write the rankings from weakest to strongest. Then solve: full house vs flush; straight vs three of a kind; AA-KK-Q vs AA-JJ-K; A-2-3-4-5; Q-K-A-2-3.

DONE WHEN

All five checks are correct, and you can explain the winner. Answers: page 28.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Kicker: a card used to break a tie between otherwise similar hands.

Follow a whole hand

Know when the cards appear, who acts and which actions are legal.

BEFORE YOU START Lesson 01.

WATCH / READ

PokerStars Learn | VIDEO

How to Play Poker for Beginners

02:27-06:30

LOOK FOR THIS

Watch blinds, betting rounds, actions and showdown. The examples here are Hold'em.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Hold'em can use zero, one or two hole cards. That rule changes in PLO; lesson 11 explains how.

DO THIS

Replay three play-money hands on paper: blinds, preflop, flop, turn, river. At each decision name the legal actions. Can you check when facing a bet? What happens when everyone folds to one player?

DONE WHEN

You reconstruct all three hands in order and answer both questions. Answers: page 28.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Hole cards: your private cards. Showdown: remaining players reveal their hands.

Why your seat matters

Identify who acts first and who has position after the flop.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 01-02.

WATCH / READ

PokerStars Learn | ARTICLE

Poker Positions Explained

Read: Positions in poker + Additional information

LOOK FOR THIS

Learn the seat names and the information gained by acting later. Skip the percentage-based opening advice for now.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

The article also discusses nine-handed tables. Your six-max order is UTG, HJ, CO, BTN, SB, BB.

DO THIS

Draw a six-max table. Label all six seats, then rotate the button. In CO vs BTN and BTN vs BB, say who acts last after the flop. Repeat with a different button seat.

DONE WHEN

Both matchups are correct, and you can explain the benefit of seeing an opponent act first. Answers: page 28.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

IP: in position, acting later. OOP: out of position, acting earlier.

Give your bet a reason

Distinguish a value bet from a bluff and from a check.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 01-03.

WATCH / READ

PokerStars Learn | ARTICLE

Purposes of Betting in Poker

Read: Value bet and Bluff definitions; Betting for Value

LOOK FOR THIS

For this first pass, learn getting called by worse versus getting better hands to fold.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Skip merged betting and advanced lines. "I want to know where I am" alone is not enough to justify a bet.

DO THIS

On a completed Hold'em board, imagine (a) the best possible hand against someone who calls worse, (b) a missed draw against someone who folds better, (c) a weak hand against someone who calls everything. State your goal in each case.

DONE WHEN

You name value, bluff and a reason to check, without using the result to justify the choice. Answers: page 28.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Value: profit from worse calls. Bluff: profit from better hands folding. Range: hands a player could have.

Work out the price of a call

Convert a call into a required percentage.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 02 and 04.

WATCH / READ

SplitSuit / The Poker Bank | VIDEO

Poker Pot Odds In 2026 (+EXAMPLES)

00:38-03:48

PokerStars Learn | ARTICLE

Pot Odds Explained

Alternative: basic formula and common bet sizes

LOOK FOR THIS

Learn call / (pot already there + your call). Use the pot after the opponent's bet, before your call.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

The threshold alone decides an all-in or river call when equity is known, ignoring rake. Earlier streets also need a plan for future bets.

DO THIS

There is $12 before the opponent bets. Calculate the threshold if they bet $6, $12 or $4. Write the complete denominator each time.

DONE WHEN

All three calculations are correct without looking at the video. Answers: page 28.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Pot odds: the price offered by the pot. Equity: your expected share at showdown.

Good decisions can lose

Separate expected value from the result of one hand.

BEFORE YOU START Lesson 05.

WATCH / READ

SplitSuit / The Poker Bank | VIDEO

The Basics Of Poker EV

00:28-03:11

LOOK FOR THIS

Watch the definition and coin-flip example. You only need basic multiplication at this stage.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Equity is a share of a showdown pot; EV is the expected profit of a decision. Neither guarantees the next result.

DO THIS

Original exercise: a fair coin pays you $4 on heads and costs you $2 on tails. Calculate average profit per flip. If the first two flips are tails, was accepting the offer a mistake?

DONE WHEN

You calculate the average and explain why two losses cannot settle decision quality. Answers: page 28.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

EV: expected value, average profit or loss. Variance: results moving around that average.

Choose Hold'em hands by seat

Use a position-specific starting reference, rather than one list for every situation.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 01-06.

WATCH / READ

SplitSuit / The Poker Bank | VIDEO

POKER RANGES 101 (What They Are & How To Use Them)

00:00-01:50: range definition and visual matrix

Upswing Poker | CHARTS

Preflop Poker Charts and Ranges

Use ONLY the Online cash 6-max UTG and BTN samples

LOOK FOR THIS

A range is a group of possible hands, not one guessed hand. Then use the linked six-max opening charts for practice.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

The public samples are a starting baseline, not a model of every NL2 pool. Ignore the live and tournament charts. Further charts require free registration.

DO THIS

Using the linked Online cash 6-max samples, classify ten unraised starting hands from UTG and BTN. Then change the situation to facing a raise: explain why the opening chart is no longer the answer.

DONE WHEN

At least 8/10 classifications agree with your reference; explain every miss and the difference between opening and facing a raise.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

RFI: raise first in, after no voluntary entry. 3-bet: a re-raise after the first preflop raise.

Value first; bluff with evidence

Name the worse hands that can call, or the better hands that can fold.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 04-07.

WATCH / READ

Jonathan Little | VIDEO

TOP 10 Cash Game TIPS! [Master The Fundamentals]

13:43-16:48: playing strong hands for value

BlackRain79 | VIDEO

16 Easy Poker Tips for BEGINNERS (Free Course)

15:46-17:06: bluffing someone who calls too much

LOOK FOR THIS

Compare building a pot with a strong hand and giving up a missed draw against a frequent caller.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

The clips use Hold'em. "Recreational player" is not a complete read, and the word "never" in a tip is not a universal poker rule.

DO THIS

Choose three marked Hold'em hands. Before revealing results, write two worse hands that might call your bet, or two better hands that might fold. If neither list is credible, explain your alternative.

DONE WHEN

You explain each bet in terms of the opponent's response, with a peer checking your assumptions. Winning the pot is not the pass criterion.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Calling tendency: observed willingness to call. Slow play: play a strong hand passively.

Review one hand properly

Turn a marked hand into one question you can actually answer.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 02-08.

WATCH / READ

SplitSuit | WORKSHEET

Poker Hand Review Template

Use the basic hand-recording fields only

Peter Clarke / Carrot Corner | VIDEO

The 5 Mental Leaks that Ruin Poker Careers

Optional: 25:41-29:32, checking the quality of a reason

LOOK FOR THIS

Record seats, stacks, board, actions and bet sizes before asking whether a play was good.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Skip the template's advanced range/line work. A reason can sound sensible while missing a more important fact.

DO THIS

Write one hand in full. Hide the result. State your decision and reason, one alternative, and one uncertainty. Review it with a peer. Finish with a sentence starting: "Next time I will check..."

DONE WHEN

Another person can reconstruct the hand and identify your question without guessing missing details.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Effective stack: the amount two players can contest. Leak: a repeated decision error.

Protect your decision-making

Recognise a tilt trigger before it changes your play.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 06 and 09.

WATCH / READ

Peter Clarke / Carrot Corner | VIDEO

The 5 Mental Leaks that Ruin Poker Careers

02:37-04:47: trigger, interpretation and response

LOOK FOR THIS

Use Peter's framework to examine your own reaction to a frustrating event.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Watch the rest only when ready. Keep poker money separate from living expenses; use the route's financial rules, not a creator's challenge.

DO THIS

Write a three-line plan: trigger (for example losing a big pot), interpretation (what you tell yourself), response (what you do). Name two signs that you should end the session. Track them for five sessions.

DONE WHEN

You can explain your plan before playing and actually follow it when a stop signal appears.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Tilt: emotion driving decisions away from your normal reasoning.

Exactly two hole cards

Build a legal PLO hand every time.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 01-03; complete the Hold'em bridge checks.

WATCH / READ

PokerStars Learn | ARTICLE

PLO Rules

Read: Rules of Omaha and the showdown example

Phil Galfond | VIDEO

Easily Fix The Most Common Beginner Mistakes in Pot Limit Omaha

Optional: short reminder about the transition

LOOK FOR THIS

Use exactly two of your four hole cards and exactly three board cards. Name the two first.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

This guide is four-card PLO high cash. Five-card PLO, Omaha Hi-Lo and tournaments need their own material.

DO THIS

Hand A♠ K♦ Q♥ J♣; board T♠ 9♠ 4♠ 3♠ 2♦: do you have a flush? Hand K♥ K♦ Q♠ J♣; board A♥ A♦ A♣ 7♠ 2♦: what is your best hand? Name the two hole cards and three board cards.

DONE WHEN

Both answers are correct. Then make five fresh examples with a peer and get all five right. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

PLO: Pot-Limit Omaha. Board: the shared community cards.

Calculate a pot-sized raise

Distinguish the call, the raise above it and the total amount put in.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 02, 05 and 11.

WATCH / READ

Omaha Poker Training | ARTICLE

How To Calculate The Pot In PLO

Read the main explanation + examples 1-5

LOOK FOR THIS

Imagine calling first. Your maximum raise above that call equals the pot after the call.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

A raise "to" and a raise "by" are different. The simple examples assume you have not already put chips in on this street and have enough chips.

DO THIS

Solve: (a) pot $12, nobody bets; (b) pot $12 before an opponent bets $6; (c) blinds $1/$2, you are first to act. Name the maximum total amount you can put in now in each case.

DONE WHEN

All three totals are correct, and you can show call-first arithmetic. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Pot-limit: a cap on the legal bet or raise. Raise to: the final bet total.

Make all four cards work

Describe a PLO starting hand through its structure.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 11-12.

WATCH / READ

Dylan Weisman / Upswing Poker | VIDEO

Pot Limit Omaha Is INCREDIBLY Easy

01:27-03:27: four starting-hand qualities

LOOK FOR THIS

Look for nut potential, connectivity, suitedness and high-pair support.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

These qualities describe a hand; they do not by themselves decide whether it is a raise, call or fold.

DO THIS

Compare A♠ K♠ Q♥ J♥ with A♠ K♦ 7♥ 2♣. Then compare A♠ A♥ K♠ K♥ with A♣ A♦ 7♠ 2♥. Describe each suit, connected ranks and supporting cards. Do not invent a percentage or action.

DONE WHEN

You identify why the first hand in each pair has more supporting structure. Verify actions later with the right preflop reference.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Double-suited: two pairs of suits. Dangler: a card that contributes little to the structure.

The same hand, a different seat

Match a PLO hand to its position and the action before you.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 03, 07 and 13.

WATCH / READ

Dylan Weisman / Upswing Poker | VIDEO

Pot Limit Omaha Is INCREDIBLY Easy

06:08-09:40: hand classes and position

LOOK FOR THIS

Use position to interpret the starting-hand qualities from lesson 13.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

The videos' examples are not a current PLO2 chart. A reference must specify four cards, cash, table size, stack depth, rake and the action.

DO THIS

In one six-max, 100bb reference, inspect five hands from UTG and BTN. Record the exact suits. Now inspect the same hands facing a raise. Write down two decisions that change and why.

DONE WHEN

You choose the correct scenario before looking at an answer and explain the changed decisions using the reference.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Rake: the room's fee. Hand class: hands grouped by a shared structure.

Aces need supporting cards

Separate having aces preflop from having a strong postflop hand.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 13-14.

WATCH / READ

Dylan Weisman / Upswing Poker | VIDEO

Pot Limit Omaha Is INCREDIBLY Easy

13:14-13:35: different kinds of aces

Phil Galfond | VIDEO

Top 5 Poker Hands You Should Fold!

05:46-06:56: overplaying a bare overpair

LOOK FOR THIS

Notice the side cards, suits, board and opponents before judging your aces.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Do not continue into automatic four-bet advice yet. Aces are valuable, but a single preflop label cannot settle every later decision.

DO THIS

Hand A♣ A♦ 7♠ 2♥. Compare flops A♠ 9♣ 4♦ and K♠ Q♠ J♥. Name your actual made hand and the strongest kinds of hands opponents can have. Explain why you cannot use one automatic c-bet rule for both.

DONE WHEN

You correctly identify your hand on both flops and explain the board difference. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Overpair: a pocket pair above every board rank. C-bet: a bet by the preflop aggressor.

The nuts now; the hand later

Identify the strongest possible hand and how a new card can change it.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 11-15.

WATCH / READ

Phil Galfond | VIDEO

Top 5 Poker Hands You Should Fold!

02:54-04:16: vulnerable two pair

Dylan Weisman / Upswing Poker | VIDEO

Pot Limit Omaha Is INCREDIBLY Easy

04:09-06:08: backup and redraws

LOOK FOR THIS

Separate the current made hand from its ability to improve or remain strong.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

The nuts on the flop can share the pot, be outdrawn or need a redraw. "Best now" is not the same as "safe on every river".

DO THIS

On 9♠ 8♠ 7♦, name the two-card combination making the nut straight. What stronger hand becomes possible when Q♠ arrives? Explain why a player holding that straight should notice the new board immediately.

DONE WHEN

You name the legal straight and the new threat, then repeat on five fresh boards. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Nuts: the best possible hand now. Redraw: a way to improve a made hand further.

Nut and non-nut flush draws

Distinguish drawing to the highest flush from drawing to a smaller one.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 11, 13 and 16.

WATCH / READ

Phil Galfond | VIDEO

Top 5 Poker Hands You Should Fold!

04:16-05:09: weak flushes and flush draws

LOOK FOR THIS

Recognise how a draw can complete and still lose to a higher flush.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

A nut flush draw is not automatically the best total hand or an automatic all-in. The board can pair and other players can have redraws.

DO THIS

On K♠ 8♠ 3♦ compare A♠ 5♠ Q♥ J♣; Q♠ J♠ 7♥ 6♣; and A♠ Q♥ J♦ 5♣. Which has the nut flush draw, a smaller flush draw, or no immediate flush draw? Explain each using two hole cards.

DONE WHEN

All three classifications are correct. You also explain why "I hit my flush" is not enough to decide a big call. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Domination: improving to a hand that still loses to a stronger version.

Count a small wrap

List straight-making ranks and count available cards once.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 11, 16 and 17.

WATCH / READ

Counting Outs | VIDEO

Understanding Wraps in Pot Limit Omaha

01:44-04:31: manual counting, nine and thirteen outs

LOOK FOR THIS

Start with the small wrap structures. Pause each diagram and name a legal two-hole-card straight.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Several hole cards can contribute through different two-card combinations. You still use exactly TWO to make any one PLO hand. Skip the larger wrap catalogue for now.

DO THIS

Hand K♣ Q♦ J♥ 4♠; flop T♠ 9♣ 2♥. List the straight-making turn ranks and count unseen cards of each. Then try Q♣ J♦ T♥ 4♠ on K♠ 9♣ 2♥. No other cards are known. Answers: page 29.

DONE WHEN

You find all the ranks and the total without counting a card twice. Repeat with a new nine-out example.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Wrap: a straight draw with more than eight straight-making outs.

An out is not always a win

Identify cards that improve you but may improve an opponent more.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 05, 17 and 18.

WATCH / READ

Phil Galfond | VIDEO

Top 5 Poker Hands You Should Fold!

05:09-05:46: weak straight draws

Counting Outs | VIDEO

Understanding Wraps in Pot Limit Omaha

08:34-08:47: nut outs matter

LOOK FOR THIS

Revisit the wrap count and separate making a straight from making the best hand.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Do not add straight outs and flush outs blindly: some cards belong to both groups. Future redraws also matter.

DO THIS

Keep K♣ Q♦ J♥ 4♠, but change the flop to T♠ 9♠ 2♥. You still have 13 straight-making turn cards. Which four can also complete an opponent's flush? How many are non-spades?

DONE WHEN

You identify all four overlapping cards and the remaining count. Explain why nine non-spades are still not a promise of winning at showdown. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Dirty out: an improving card that may leave you behind. Overlap: a card counted in two draws.

Measure the stack behind

Calculate effective stack and stack-to-pot ratio before a big decision.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 05, 12 and 16.

WATCH / READ

SplitSuit / The Poker Bank | VIDEO

What Is SPR?

00:25-01:07: formula and example ONLY

LOOK FOR THIS

Borrow the arithmetic from this Hold'em video: remaining effective stack / current pot.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Stop at 01:07. The video then gives Hold'em commitment shortcuts; those are not PLO stack-off rules. Multiway side pots also need more than one effective stack.

DO THIS

Heads-up on the flop: pot $12, you have $72 left, opponent has $48 left. Calculate the effective stack and SPR. Repeat with pot $10, your stack $90, opponent $40. What else must you know before committing?

DONE WHEN

Both ratios are correct, and you mention hand strength, board and opponent range. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

SPR: stack-to-pot ratio, a measure of how much money remains relative to the pot.

Pause before building a pot

Recognise why a preflop raise does not require betting every flop.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 15-20.

WATCH / READ

Phil Galfond | VIDEO

Top 5 Poker Hands You Should Fold!

05:46-06:56: the bare-overpair example

Dylan Weisman / Upswing Poker | VIDEO

5 Preflop Mistakes You Are Probably Making In Pot Limit Omaha

03:29-06:20: domination in multiway pots

LOOK FOR THIS

Compare a vulnerable hand with a hand that has strong supporting draws, especially against several opponents.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Checking does not mean surrendering. Treat the clips as explanations of risk, not fixed betting frequencies or a rule to fold every non-nut hand.

DO THIS

Mark five PLO flops. For each, record: number of opponents, position, current made hand, best possible hand and redraws. Give a reason to bet or check; review the most uncertain case with a peer.

DONE WHEN

You explain all five using the board and opponents, rather than "I raised preflop." A peer checks the assumptions before you adopt a new strategy.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Multiway: three or more players still in the hand. Board texture: how the shared cards connect.

A blocker removes possibilities

Explain card removal without treating it as permission to bluff.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 11, 16, 17 and 21.

WATCH / READ

SplitSuit | ARTICLE

Poker Combos & Blockers 101

Read: What Are Blockers In Poker? + ace example only

LOOK FOR THIS

Learn the definition from Hold'em, then apply the two-card rule to the PLO exercise.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Skip combo-counting systems, bluff construction and advanced range work. Owning the ace of a suit does not itself make a PLO flush.

DO THIS

Hand A♠ K♦ Q♥ J♣; river board 9♠ 6♠ 2♠ 7♥ 3♦. Can an opponent have an ace-high spade flush? Can they have a king-high spade flush? Do you have a flush yourself? Does the ace force them to fold?

DONE WHEN

All four answers are correct and you distinguish a blocker from a made hand. Answers: page 29.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Blocker: a known card that removes combinations using that card.

Make preflop practice a habit

Practise small batches and explain errors instead of chasing a score.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 13-15; understand the correct format and scenario.

WATCH / READ

PLO Mastermind | GUIDE

What is PLO Mastermind Starter?

Read: free access + How does PLO Trainer work?

PLO Mastermind | TOOL

Starter: free account and four-card preflop practice

Practice: FOUR-card, six-max cash preflop

LOOK FOR THIS

Start with raise-first-in decisions. Then, separately, study facing a raise, 3-betting and facing a 3-bet.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

Starter requires a free account. Its small-stakes model is a study reference, not a perfect PLO2 pool model. Check rake and stacks; ask a coach about meaningful differences.

DO THIS

Do 20 RFI decisions from one seat on each of three separate days. For every error, record the hand, suits, action and one structural reason. Repeat five missed examples later without viewing the answer.

DONE WHEN

Keep three dated practice logs and explain each recurring error. Use accuracy as feedback; these study checks do not qualify you to move stakes.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Baseline: a starting reference to compare with. Accuracy: agreement with the selected model.

One study target each week

Connect videos, preflop practice and your own hands through one recurring problem.

BEFORE YOU START Lessons 09-10 and 16-23.

WATCH / READ

Peter Clarke / Carrot Corner | VIDEO

The 5 Mental Leaks that Ruin Poker Careers

Revisit: 25:41-29:32, sufficient reasons

PLO Mastermind | GUIDE

What is PLO Mastermind Starter?

Reference: preflop scenarios and free practice

LOOK FOR THIS

Choose the lesson matching your current error. Rewatch its short segment, practise it, then test it in reviewed hands.

KEEP THE SCOPE SMALL

This curriculum supports the route; it does not replace its volume, bankroll or evaluation requirements. Finishing lessons is not proof of beating PLO50.

DO THIS

Weekly plan: choose one error; do three short preflop batches; mark five relevant PLO hands; review one with a peer or coach; write what changed and what remains uncertain. Save a dated record.

DONE WHEN

You complete the plan for four weeks and can show a repeated error, the work done and evidence of improvement in decisions.

WORDS YOU WILL MEET

Study target: one specific error you are trying to reduce, not a vague goal to "get better."

Check your basics

01 Rankings

Full house; straight; AA-KK-Q; A-2-3-4-5 is a straight; Q-K-A-2-3 is not a straight. A royal flush is the highest straight flush.

02 Actions and streets

No checking when facing an unmatched bet. The last remaining player wins without showing the best hand. Streets: preflop, flop, turn, river.

03 Position

BTN acts last in both CO vs BTN and BTN vs BB. With six players, UTG acts first preflop; the first active player left of BTN acts first postflop.

04 Why bet?

The intended goals are value in (a), bluff in (b), and usually checking in (c). A goal still needs evidence about the opponent and the price.

05 Price of a call

$6: 6/(12+6+6)=25%. $12: 12/(12+12+12)=33.3%. $4: 4/(12+4+4)=20%. Ignore rake in these exercises.

06 Expected value

EV = 0.5 x $4 - 0.5 x $2 = +$1 per flip. Two tails lose $4, but the offer is still profitable in expectation. More trials do not guarantee recovery on a deadline.

Lessons 07-10 use a reference or a review, not a single universal poker action. Keep the hand details and your reason so another person can check them.

Check your PLO drills

11 Exactly two. First hand: no flush, because you have only one spade. Second hand: aces full of kings, using K♥ K♦ + A♥ A♦ A♣.

12 Pot-sized raise. (a) $12. (b) Call $6, making a $24 pot; raise $24 more, for $30 total. (c) Call $2, making a $5 pot; raise $5 more, for $7 total.

15 Aces. On A♠ 9♣ 4♦ you have top set. On K♠ Q♠ J♥ you have only an overpair, with no spade draw; opponents can hold straights, sets, two pair and strong draws. Your aces alone do not choose the action.

16 Changing nuts. JT makes the nut straight on 9♠ 8♠ 7♦. The Q♠ turn makes a flush possible for an opponent with two spades; a straight is no longer the nuts. Always account for exactly two hole cards.

17 Flush draws. A♠ 5♠ Q♥ J♣ has the nut flush draw; Q♠ J♠ 7♥ 6♣ has a queen-high flush draw; A♠ Q♥ J♦ 5♣ has only one spade and no immediate flush draw.

18 Wrap count. First: K, Q, J and 8 give 3+3+3+4 = 13 straight-making cards. Second: Q, J and T give 3+3+3 = 9. Neither count means guaranteed wins by the river.

19 Dirty outs. K♠, Q♠, J♠ and 8♠ can complete a flush. The other nine straight-making turn cards are non-spades. An opponent can still improve on the river, and ranges determine the full equity.

20 SPR. First: $48 effective, SPR 4. Second: $40 effective, SPR 4. Equal SPR does not imply an equal decision; cards, ranges, position and action still matter.

22 Blocker. No opponent ace-high spade flush because you hold A♠. A king-high spade flush is possible. You have no flush with only one spade. The blocker does not force folds or justify an automatic bluff.

Three optional viewing choices

Charlie Carrel | After lessons 07-10

High Stakes Tournament Player Crushing $0.01/$0.02 (Day 2 Bankroll Challenge)

Actual NL2 footage from the older challenge. Watch one short part for interest and pause before a decision to explain your own choice.

Edited 2018 play; chat and entertainment interrupt the teaching. His aggressive challenge bankroll and fast moves up are not your financial plan.

Bart Hanson / Crush Live Poker | After lessons 07-09

How to HAND READ in POKER

A $1/$2 straddled cash-hand discussion. Use 00:17-02:19 to practise reconstructing seats, stacks and actions; later analysis is optional.

The straddle and opponent history change the situation. Read betting-pattern claims as hypotheses, not certainty, and do not transfer Hold'em hand strength to PLO.

JNandez | After lessons 16-24, preferably with a coach

How to Beat Low Stakes PLO and Move Up Fast in 2026

Use 06:26-07:01 for the reminder to study one format. The full hour can become later prediction-and-review practice.

This is PLO100/PLO200 exploitative play, not an introductory PLO course. HUD reads, leads and blocker-driven check-raises need more knowledge than a beginner has.

Why these selections fit

INDIVIDUAL LESSONS, NOT WHOLE CHANNELS

The selections span PokerStars Learn, SplitSuit, Jonathan Little, BlackRain79, Peter Clarke, Dylan Weisman, Phil Galfond, Counting Outs and PLO Mastermind, with gated Charlie Carrel, Bart Hanson and JNandez viewing.

WHAT WAS CHECKED

Eighteen candidate video transcripts were retrieved through the logged-in Chrome profile. Selected segments were read for topic, prerequisites and teaching scope; official written lessons were checked alongside them. This was transcript and page review, not an end-to-end audiovisual audit.

WHY SOME VIDEOS ARE ONLY PARTLY USED

The preflop-mistakes video proceeds into four-bet bluffs after 06:20. The SPR video proceeds into Hold'em commitment shortcuts after 01:07. JNandez's existing route selection is a PLO100/PLO200 session. Those sections are not day-one instructions.

ACCESS AND CHANGE

Core videos and written lessons were publicly accessible when checked. PLO Mastermind practice needs a free account; its assumptions are visible in the linked help page. If a source disappears, use the lesson objective to select a replacement at the same level.